

What A Process Map Is

A picture of how work actually flows from start to finish, drawn as boxes and arrows everyone can see.

The Basics

A process map is the simplest of the three artifacts in this module. It takes something that lives invisibly in people's heads and scattered handoffs and draws it as boxes and arrows so everyone can finally see the same thing. It sounds too basic to matter, but it is quietly one of the most powerful tools you will pick up.

Where Waste Hides

Most waste is not in the steps people talk about. It hides in the gaps between them. The handoff where work sits in a queue for two days. The rework loop nobody mentions. The approval step that exists only because of something that went wrong five years ago. You cannot fix what you cannot see, and the map makes it all visible at once.

Where AI Fits

The real skill is not just drawing a map but validating it. Beginners draw a beautiful map in a conference room, feel proud, and never check it against reality. AI drafts clean structure from a messy description in seconds, but it cannot walk the floor or notice the workaround someone invented to survive. That part is yours.

Remember this

A process map is a truth-telling exercise, not a drawing exercise.